Raiders of the Hidden Temple



A 4th-level ShadowDark adventure by Kelsey Dionne

Raiders of the Hidden Temple





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ShadowDark



Overview

A dubious treasure map led the characters deep into the sweltering jungles of Tal-Yool. Now, a ruined **temple** stands before them.

Do they dare enter to claim the fabled *Chalice of the Blood Queen* said to be inside?

INHABITANTS

The temple houses an ancient order of **viperians** whose leader, **Shanti**, was given the immortal gift of vampirism long ago.

In exchange for this power, Shanti swore to guard the ***Chalice of the Blood Queen***, an artifact that belongs to her mother vampire (who has not been seen in two centuries).

Some of Shanti's disciples have begun to doubt her power and purpose. An upstart viperian wizard, **Gorgoroth**, secretly plots to kill her and take her place as leader. He wants to return the focus of the order to the worship of their snake goddess, **Nathrexis**, rather than "guarding a bauble for a long-gone vampire who cares nothing for us."

RANDOM ENCOUNTERS

d4	Details
1	A **cobra** fitted with several decorative gold cuffs
2	2d4 **viperians** shaking ritualistic snake-tail rattles
3	1d6 **stingbats** flutter in from a crack in the wall
4	The **vampirodile** (Area 13) waddles into the room

THE TEMPLE

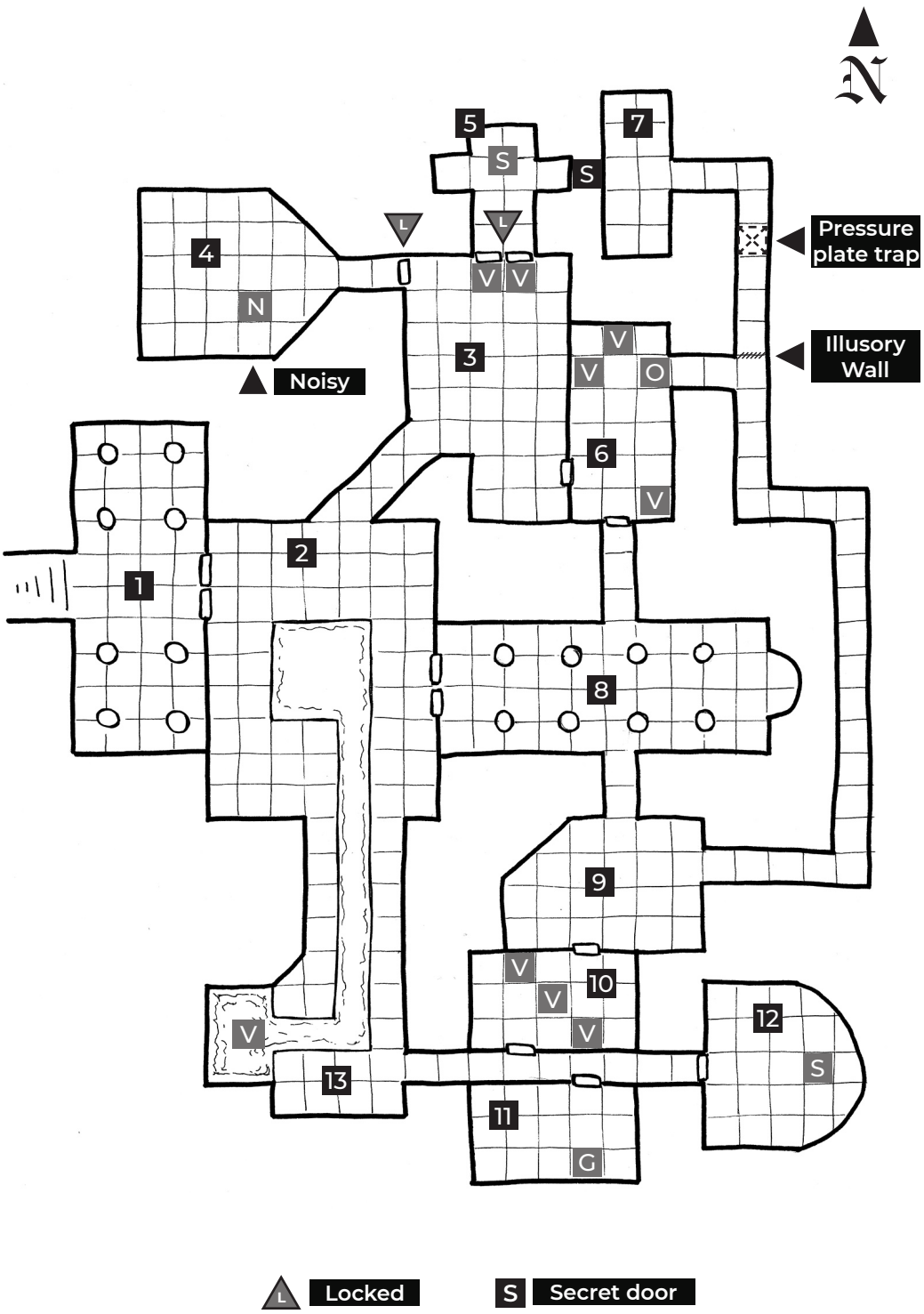
Water-stained, cyclopean stones dusted in moss and vines. Chunks of masonry crumble and fall away into rubble. Dense and vibrant jungle surrounds the silent complex.

Danger Level. Unsafe. Check for an encounter every **3** crawling rounds.

Light. Total darkness.

THE CHALICE

The *Chalice of the Blood Queen* is a crimson goblet cut from a single ruby that constantly overflows with fresh blood. It can turn one who drinks a full gulp of the blood into a vampire, if they wish.


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Pressure plate trap
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Illusory Wall
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L Locked
S Secret door

Areas 1-13

1. Snake Doors. Broken pillars stand beside **double doors** carved with knotted snakes and a phrase in Reptilian: "A snake shall always find safe passage."

- **Door Trap.** The doors slap anyone who walks through them on foot rather than belly crawling like a snake (DC 15 DEX or 1d8 damage).

2. Grand Hall. Swooping hall draped in vines that burst though the walls and ceiling. Gurgling **pool** of dark water dotted with lily pads. Furious **screaming** echoes from northwest.

- **Pool.** 10' deep. PCs who look into the water see warped reflections of their own faces with snakelike features. DC 12 CHA or be hypnotized for 1d4 rounds.
  - 1:6 chance each PC who looks spots an **emerald** (120 gp) on the bottom (limit once per PC).
  - Disturbing the water causes the next random encounter to be with the **vampirodile** (Area 13).
- **Screaming.** Nilo, a starving and furious vampire spawn sealed inside Area 4.

3. Viperians. Two snake-people (**viperians**) pray on reed mats before the door to Area 5. They beg Shanti to emerge; she has been inside for two months. Banging and howling comes from behind the west door.

- **Viperians.** Alessa and Tyros. Manipulative, loyal to Shanti.
  - They are savvy and see PCs as an opportunity. They lie that an evil wizard (**Gorgoroth**, Area 11) has cursed them to look like snakes and has placed a sleep spell on their queen. They say the screaming man in Area 4 is one of the wizard's cronies.
- **Noise.** Nilo (see Area 4). He begs in Reptilian to be released.

4. Destroyed Shrine. Locked **door** (DC 20 STR or DEX). Shredded reed mats, overturned stone altar, and caved-in bronze sculpture of many-headed snake (40 gp). A furious, gaunt viperian (**vampire spawn**) flings himself around the room, smashing everything he touches.

- **Nilo.** Shanti's spurned lover. He screams and pleads to be let out. He has been locked inside for two months and is famished.

5. Shanti's Room. Locked **door** (DC 20 DEX or STR). Shanti, a stunning viperian, sleeps inside a **bronze sarcophagus** carved with her likeness. She has refused to emerge since she learned **Nilo** (Area 4) was telling **Gorgoroth** (Area 11) her secrets. She wishes them both dead and will get around to it, eventually.

- **Secret Door.** A wall panel opens into Area 7. Shanti drinks from the *Chalice of the Blood Queen* stored within to sate her hunger.

6. Skinning Room. Three snake-faced people (**viperians**) sit and chant hymns in Reptilian while they cut and pluck at objects they hold. A towering anaconda with a human torso (**viperian ophid**) coils with her arms crossed, watching the hallway.

- **Viperians.** Mazimar, Vireen, Hestus. They **sing** of the fallen viperian empire while skinning rare jungle creatures (red monkey, razor-billed toucan, opaline iguana) to try to tempt Shanti out of her chamber with her favorite blood offerings.
- **Ophid.** Ralassa. Shanti's second-in-command. Severe, practical. She prays her queen will emerge to deal with **Gorgoroth** (Area 11), who she believes will soon attack Shanti's chambers. She is wiley and tries to use the PCs to her ends with lies or truth.

7. Treasure Room. An **illusory wall** hides the passage to Area 7 (touch reveals it is insubstantial). Inside is a stone chest with glittering **treasures** placed on top of it.

- **Trap.** Pressure plate on floor releases a boulder overhead that moves double near on the GM's turn down the hall toward Area 9. Any creature it passes through takes 2d8 damage (DC 15 DEX to avoid). Boulder poofs out of existence when it reaches Area 9.
- **Treasure.** Giant **emerald** set into a thick girdle belt of snakeskin (240 gp). Stone **chest** filled with 1,000 gp. ***Chalice of the Blood Queen*** (see front of adventure).
- **Secret Door.** A wall panel opens into Area 5.

8. Chapel. High walls reach into darkness with **pillars** carved as giant anacondas rearing to strike. A wide **dais** at the rear stands empty (inspection reveals a large, circular object once stood upon it). Restless **bats** (harmless) flutter in the shadowy heights.

- **Secret Compartment.** The floor of the dais has a hidden compartment. Inside, an immortal, albino **cobra** wraps around a suit of *Ophidian Armor* (Shadowdark RPG pg. 309. +1 leather, wielder ADV vs. poison).

9. Mosaic Hall. Glittering **mosaics** cover the walls. Some show the brass-domed jungle cities of the viperian empire (long fallen). Others depict a war between white-robed viperians and red-scaled lizardfolk.

- **Fortune.** PCs who study the mosaics gain a luck token granted by the snake goddess Nathrexis (once per PC).

10. Religious Fanatics. Three **viperians** dance, beat drums, and shake snake tail rattles. Each has a wooden stake thrust into their belt.

- **Viperians.** Yaresk, Zulane, Kest. They **pray** for their goddess, Nathrexis, to bring doom upon the unfaithful vampire Shanti.
  - ▸ **Ritual.** If even one completes the dance after 3 rounds, the locked door to Area 5 cracks open with a thunderous boom.

11. Gorgoroth's Chamber. A messy bed chamber strewn with books. A thin, scowling snake-man in red robes (**viperian wizard**) hunches over a table reading from a tome. He hisses and mumbles to himself.

- **Viperian Wizard.** Gorgoroth. He has a wooden stake tucked into his sash and reads astrological projections about the best time to attack Shanti. He **offers** PCs who help him the *Chalice of the Blood Queen* (if they can find it).

12. Snake God Statue. An oversized **statue** of a multi-armed snake woman sits on a circular base. It holds out a golden **staff** with a curved, ruby-eyed cobra head (*Staff of the Cobra*, Shadowdark RPG pg. 317). Taking the staff causes the statue to animate into a hostile **stone golem** for 1d4 rounds.

13. Pool Wellspring. A burbling **pool** of water flows from an alcove into a floor channel. Suspended above it from chains is a **stone statue** of a lizard man. It slowly drips blood from its mouth into the water.

- **Pool.** 10' deep. PCs who look into the water see warped reflections of their own faces with snakelike features. DC 12 CHA or be hypnotized for 1d4 rounds.
- **Vampirodile.** Shanti's pet. It lurks under the water and leaps out to attack creatures at the edge of the pool.
- **Statue.** Brask, a partially petrified **lizardfolk** warrior condemned to eternal suffering. Shanti put him here to nourish her vampirodile.

Monsters

GOLEM, STONE

A wide-limbed, lumbering statue that shakes the ground.

AC 18, **HP** 40, **ATK** 3 slam +6 (1d10) and 1 slow, **MV** near, **S** +4, **D** -1, **C** +4, **I** -2, **W** +0, **Ch** -2, **AL** N, **LV** 8

Golem. Immune to damage from fire, cold, electricity, or non-magical sources.

Slow. Far range, one target. DC 15 CON or speed halved 1d4 rds.

SNAKE, COBRA

A weaving serpent with a neck hood and lethal venom.

AC 12, **HP** 4, **ATK** 1 bite +2 (1 + poison), **MV** near, **S** -3, **D** +2, **C** +0, **I** -3, **W** +0, **Ch** -3, **AL** N, **LV** 1

Poison. DC 18 CON or go to 0 HP with a death timer of 1.



STINGBAT

Darting, orange insect-bat with four wings and needlelike beak.

AC 12, **HP** 4, **ATK** 1 beak +2 (1d4 + blood drain), **MV** near (fly), **S** -2, **D** +2, **C** +0, **I** -2, **W** +0, **Ch** -2, **AL** N, **LV** 1

Blood Drain. Attach to bitten target; auto-hit the next round. DC 9 STR on turn to remove.

VAMPIRODILE

Fat, scaly reptiles with stumpy legs and long, thrashing tails.

AC 14, **HP** 20, **ATK** 2 bite +3 (1d8 + blood drain), **MV** near (swim), **S** +3, **D** +1, **C** +2, **I** -2, **W** +1, **Ch** -2, **AL** N, **LV** 4

Greater Undead. Immune to morale checks. Only damaged by silver or magical sources.

Blood Drain. Vampire heals 2d6 HP and target permanently loses 1d4 CON. At 0 CON, target dies and rises as a vampire spawn.

Vampire. Must sleep in blood-tinged water or takes 2d8 damage and can't rest. Cannot be killed unless pierced through heart with a wooden stake while at 0 HP.

VAMPIRE

Pale, blood-drinking undead of supreme power and wickedness. They loathe sunlight and protect their coffins at all costs.

AC 15, **HP** 52, **ATK** 3 bite +7 (1d8 + blood drain) or 1 charm, **MV** near (climb), **S** +4, **D** +3, **C** +3, **I** +1, **W** +3, **Ch** +4, **AL** C, **LV** 11

Supreme Undead. Immune to morale checks. Only damaged by magical sources.

Blood Drain. Vampire heals 2d6 HP and target permanently loses 1d4 CON. At 0 CON, target dies and rises as vampire or vampire spawn (vampire chooses).

Charm. One humanoid target who can see vampire within near, DC 15 CHA or under vampire's control for 1d4 days.

Shapechange. In place of attacks, turn into a bat, wolf, or back into regular form.

Vampire. Must sleep in a coffin daily or loses 2d6 HP each day that can't be healed until resting in coffin. Takes 3d8 damage each round while in direct sunlight. Cannot be killed unless pierced through heart with a wooden stake while at 0 HP.

VAMPIRE SPAWN

Lesser, feral vampires born from the bite of their vampiric sires. Bloodthirsty and savage. They rarely leave a victim alive.

AC 13 (leather), **HP** 25, **ATK** 2 bite +4 (1d8 + blood drain), **MV** near (climb), **S** +3, **D** +2, **C** +3, **I** -1, **W** +1, **Ch** +2, **AL** C, **LV** 5

Greater Undead. Immune to morale checks. Only damaged by silver or magical sources.

Blood Drain. Vampire heals 2d6 HP and target permanently loses 1d4 CON. At 0 CON, target dies and rises as a vampire spawn.

Vampire. Must sleep in a coffin daily or loses 2d6 HP each day that can't be healed until resting in coffin. Takes 3d8 damage each round while in direct sunlight. Cannot be killed unless pierced through heart with a wooden stake while at 0 HP.



VIPERIAN

Lithe, snake-headed people with cobra hoods and emerald green scales covering their bodies.

AC 13, **HP** 13, **ATK** 2 scimitar +2 (1d6) or 1 javelin (close/far) +2 (1d4), **MV** near, **S** +1, **D** +1, **C** +0, **I** +0, **W** +1, **Ch** +0, **AL** C, **LV** 3

VIPERIAN, OPHID

A giant anaconda body merges into a humanoid torso with a large snake head. It wears golden torcs and strings of glittering moonstones.

AC 14, **HP** 28, **ATK** 3 falchion +5 (1d10) or 2 longbow (far) +3 (1d8), **MV** near (climb), **S** +4, **D** +2, **C** +1, **I** +1, **W** +1, **Ch** +1, **AL** C, **LV** 6

Impervious. Can only be harmed by magical sources.

VIPERIAN, WIZARD

Thin viperians with scales tinged in black. They wear silk robes and silver, serpentine jewelry.

AC 13, **HP** 37, **ATK** 1 dagger (close/near) +2 (1d4) or 2 spell +5, **MV** near, **S** +0, **D** +1, **C** +0, **I** +3, **W** +1, **Ch** +1, **AL** C, **LV** 8

Hiss (INT Spell). DC 12. End one spell within far.

Summon Cobra (INT Spell). DC 13. Summon 1d4 loyal cobras that appear within near. They leave in 1d4 rounds.

Venom (INT Spell). DC 12. One target in far takes 2d8 damage.

Whispers (INT Spell). DC 14. Focus. All enemies within near of viperian wizard have DISADV on spellcasting checks for the duration.

